

Lesson 13

1. N+ とは

What is... / ...means... / ...is defined as...

Used to define or explain the meaning or nature of a word, concept, or thing. It sounds formal and is common in definitions, explanations, academic writing, and formal questions.

～とは is a more formal version of ～というのは. It introduces a topic and is followed by an explanation of its meaning, definition, or essential nature.

例：

1. 愛とは何ですか。
2. 幸せとは、お金だけで決まるものではない。
3. 「コンビニ」とは、コンビニエンスストアのことである。

2. ～といえは

A. Speaking of... / Talking of... / When you mention...

Used when a word or topic comes up in conversation and the speaker picks up that word and moves to another related topic or thought.

It attaches directly to a word taken from what the other person said, what the speaker was talking about, or something that came to mind. That word becomes the link to a new, related topic.

例：

1. 日本といえは、富士山を思い浮かべる人が多いです。
2. 夏といえは、やっぱり海ですね。
3. 京都といえは、去年家族と旅行したんですよ。

B: ～といえは

“It is X, if you put it that way, but...” / “You could say X, but...”

The speaker partially accepts that something is true, but does not fully agree with it. After acknowledging it, they add a qualification, reservation, or contrasting opinion.

例：

1. 高いといえば高いけど、買えないほどではない。
2. 難しいといえば難しいですが、できないことはありません。
3. ～というと・～といえば・～といったら

Speaking of... / When you mention... / When it comes to...

Used when a word or topic makes the speaker immediately think of something strongly associated with it.

～というと can also be used to confirm what the other person means, as in ④ and ⑤. It often appears with expressions such as ～ね, ～ですか, ～かな, showing that the speaker is checking their understanding.

例：

1. 日本というと、富士山を思い浮かべます。
2. 春といえば、桜ですね。北海道といったら、やっぱり雪でしょう。

Nuance Difference

～といえば → Speaking of that... → related topic

～というと → When you say that... → association that comes to mind

～といったら → When it comes to X... Similar here, but more conversational and can carry a stronger feeling or emphasis.

日本というと、富士山を思い浮かべます。

When I think of Japan, Mt. Fuji comes to mind.

日本といえば、やっぱり富士山ですね。

Speaking of Japan, it has to be Mt. Fuji.

日本といたら、やっぱり富士山でしょう。

When it comes to Japan, surely Mt. Fuji!

4. ～（のこと） となると

When it comes to... / When the subject is...

Used when someone shows a different or unusual attitude or behaviour regarding one particular topic. It emphasizes: normally they are one way, but when it comes to X

例：

1. 彼は仕事には厳しいが、子どものこととなるととても優しい。
2. 母は旅行のこととなると、急に元気になる。
3. 田中さんは普段静かだが、野球のこととなるとよくしゃべる。

Nuance Difference: ～となると vs ～といえば

～といえば → Speaking of X... X triggers an associated idea or another related topic.

日本といえば、富士山ですね。

Speaking of Japan, Mt. Fuji comes to mind.

～となると → When it comes specifically to X... someone's attitude or behavior becomes noticeably different.

富士山のこととなると、父は何時間でも話す。

When it comes to Mt. Fuji, my father will talk for hours.

5. ～といたら

When it comes to... / It was incredibly... / You can't imagine how...

Used to emphasize that the degree of something is extremely high. The speaker expresses a strong feeling, impression, surprise, admiration, complaint, etc.

Used when the speaker wants to strongly emphasize how amazing, terrible, beautiful, difficult, etc. something is. It carries strong emotion and is more emphatic than simply describing something with an adjective.

例：

1. 北海道の冬の寒さといったら、本当に厳しい。
2. 試験前の忙しさといったら、寝る時間もないほどだった。
3. 彼女の歌の美しさといったら、言葉では表せない。
4. 昨日の暑さといったら、外を歩けないほどだった。

Nuance Difference: ～といったら (③) vs ～といったら (⑤)

～といったら (association) → When you think of X...; introduces something associated with X.

北海道といったら、雪を思い浮かべます。

When you think of Hokkaido, snow comes to mind.

～といったら (degree/emphasis) → X is incredibly...; expresses the speaker's strong emotional reaction to the degree.

北海道の冬の寒さといったら、本当に厳しい。

The winter cold in Hokkaido is incredibly severe.